ESL Brains

Can we measure happiness?

1. **Read the quotes and do the tasks below.**

> *"They say a person needs just three things to be truly happy in this world: someone to love, something to do, and something to hope for."* – Tom Bodett, writer

> *"Happiness is not a goal... it's a by-product of a life well-lived."*
> – Eleanor Roosevelt, political figure and human rights advocate

> *"Success is getting what you want. Happiness is wanting what you get."*
> – Dale Carnegie, writer

A. Say which quote you agree with most and why.

B. Say what happiness means to you.

2. **Decide which two items in the boxes are the most important for your happiness and which two are the least important. Give more details.**

relationships	health	meaningful work	freedom
security	achievements	money	enough free time

3. **Say to what extent you agree or disagree with the statements. Give examples.**

- The older you become, the happier you feel.
- Comparing yourself to other people makes you more unhappy.
- A person can have a good quality of life and still be unhappy.
- You can experience negative emotions and still be happy.
- People in richer countries are happier than people in poorer countries.

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4. **Read about the World Happiness Report and discuss the questions below.**

> The World Happiness Report looks at how happy people are with their lives in different countries around the world. The rankings are based mainly on people's own evaluations of their lives and they are asked to rate their lives on a scale of 0–10.

- Do you think this ranking shows the real situation? Why/Why not?
- What factors do you think researchers use to measure happiness?
- Which countries would you expect to be at the top of the list? Where do you think your country would be?
- Is it possible to measure happiness? Why/Why not?

5. **Watch a video [https://youtu.be/5Xdsad54IJs] about the country that was voted the happiest in the world in 2025 and some possible reasons. Say if you agree with any of the reasons mentioned.**

6. **Discuss the questions.**

- Were you surprised by any of the things mentioned in the video?
- Do you agree that social media can make us more unhappy? Why/Why not?
- Apart from going to a sauna, what other forms of relaxation can improve your happiness?
- What do you think governments can do to make people in their country happier?



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7. Look at the options and say which country you would be happier in. Give reasons.

a country where life is very safe but there are lots of rules	**or**	a country where people have more freedom but life is less safe
a country with lots of career opportunities but a high cost of living	**or**	a country with fewer career opportunities but a lower cost of living
a country with great public services but high taxes	**or**	a country with lower taxes but fewer public services
a country with big, exciting cities but little access to nature	**or**	a country with smaller towns but easy access to nature
a country where shops and services are available almost all the time	**or**	a country where things close early but people have a better work-life balance

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